

INTRODUCTION



Before discussing specifics like insurance, inheritance, and retirement, it's important to repeat that unless a husband and wife are willing to work together, they will never achieve God's best, because God treats them as a unified team.

First and foremost, a husband and wife must commit to spending some time together alone, developing their goals.

The topics discussed in this section pertain to long-range planning. In order to do long-range planning, you must first do short-range planning. So work on your budget first, as previously discussed.

I suggest that a husband and wife set aside at least half a day by themselves (without children along) and begin the planning process. Before you begin, you need to pray together and ask God to give you the wisdom His Word promises: "But if any of you lacks wisdom, let him ask of God, who gives to all men generously and without reproach, and it will be given to him" (James 1:5).

You won't be able to do all of your long-range planning in one day. The best you can do initially is talk about your goals and get started. Once you have decided how much of your children's education you will pay for and how much they will be responsible for, at least you'll have a starting point. The same is true of selecting the amount and type of life insurance and how much inheritance you want to leave to your children.